

is a complete Linux platform that has most of the electronics design software (including gEDA) preinstalled. The download link and installation instruction can be found at 'www.spins.fedoraproject.org/fel/#downloads

gEDA manager

The manuals on the Internet explain the overall functionality of gEDA suite with block diagram shown in Fig. 1. All the different packages under gEDA suite have to be linked somehow. According to the manuals, gEDA manager is the simplest way of doing it. But gEDA manager is not really available anywhere on the Internet. Another way to do it is through command line. It is also very simple but the way things are done is not like we do in Windows, which is why people find it less user-friendly. But, it is just different, not difficult!

Documentation

Most of the documentation available on the Internet is sometimes very confusing and not very recent. Different documents depict use of gEDA suite differently, making it difficult for a new user to understand the design flow. Here is an attempt to simplify the things.

Install gEDA suite following the standard procedure, which depends on the operating system used. Complete installation instructions are available at 'wiki.geda-project.org/geda:installation.' If FEL is used, gEDA suite is preinstalled and ready to use.

'gschem' package is used for schematic entry and new symbol generation. Before you start entering a new schematic, you have to do some configuration settings to define things like a directory having custom symbols and background colour. Fig. 2 shows 'gschem' with black background.

The configuration files are at 'home/.geda/' ('.geda' is a hidden file). To set up the directory for putting in the new custom-made symbols and make sure that they are linked to the main library, create a folder 'gaf' in the home directory. Here names used are the same as in official manuals of gEDA so that it is easy to relate with. In

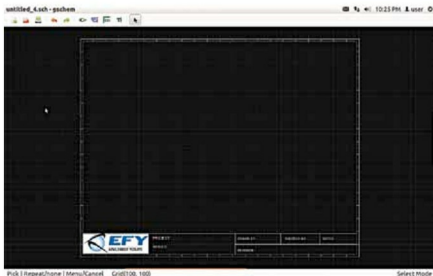


Fig. 2: gschem with black background

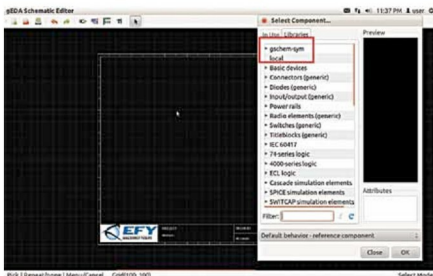


Fig. 3: Custom symbols linked

the folder, make a sub-directory with the name 'gschem-sym' to save all the custom symbols.

To link this folder to the main library, go to 'home/.geda/'. Make a new document and name it 'gafrc.' Open this document with a text editor and type '(component-library "\$[HOME]/gaf/gchem-sym")'. Save the file and exit. This will tell 'gschem' that custom symbols are in 'home/gaf/gchem-sym.'

Once you restart 'gschem,' a new configuration file takes effect and the folder having all the custom-made symbols is linked in the main library as shown in Fig. 3.

Personalisation setting can be done with another configuration file called 'gschemrc.' In the directory 'home/.geda/', create another file and name it 'gschemrc.' Open this file with a text editor and write series of commands depending on the personalisation settings that you require, say, light background. Save it and exit. The detailed commands can be found at 'wiki.geda-project.org/geda:gschem_ug.config.'

After configuration, you can immediately start entering the schematic by choosing the symbols from the library. Schematic entry is very comfortable in gEDA. You can refer to 'wiki.geda-project.org/geda:gschem_ug' for a